

Legal hold procedure

COM-005 | Compliance | SOP | Version 2.0

Document control	Value
Access level	CONFIDENTIAL
Effective date	2026-04-01
Status	current
Owner	Compliance process owner
Scope	Meridian Works fictional enterprise; all locations unless stated otherwise

Purpose and scope

This SOP describes legal hold procedure for Meridian Works. It is part of a wholly fictional enterprise knowledge base created for SynapseIQ retrieval experiments. The rules and figures below are invented operational assumptions, not real company rules or professional guidance.

Key requirements

1. Only the designated legal coordinator can release a hold.
2. Custodians acknowledge hold notices within two working days.
3. The normal retention schedule resumes only after release.

Authority: effective from 2026-04-01. If a local quick guide disagrees, use the current approved controlling policy and record the discrepancy.

Legal hold procedure - 2/3

Procedure and responsibilities

1. The requester states the business purpose and affected scope. Only the designated legal coordinator can release a hold.
2. The assigned owner checks completeness and applies the relevant rule. Custodians acknowledge hold notices within two working days.
3. The reviewer records the decision, required evidence and any approved exception. The requester receives the case reference and next action.
4. The owner verifies completion, documents any unresolved issue and schedules a review if the arrangement remains active.

Role	Responsibility
Requester	Provide scope, requested period and synthetic supporting evidence
Compliance owner	Interpret the requirement and assign a decision owner
Independent reviewer	Check approval limits and exception evidence
Record custodian	Retain the case according to the applicable schedule

Worked scenario

Example SYN-COM-005-02: the Cedar project team submits a request with an incomplete review date. The owner returns the case for clarification instead of assuming approval. Once the date and scope are supplied, the rule is applied and the decision is logged.

Exception and evidence

An exception must name the approving role, limited scope and expiry. A verbal suggestion or old FAQ does not override the controlling requirement. Store evidence in the authorized workspace and preserve version context.

Related search terms

Legal hold procedure; Compliance; retention, evidence, legal hold, access review

Legal hold procedure - 3/3

Procedure and responsibilities

1. The requester states the business purpose and affected scope. Custodians acknowledge hold notices within two working days.
2. The assigned owner checks completeness and applies the relevant rule. The normal retention schedule resumes only after release.
3. The reviewer records the decision, required evidence and any approved exception. The requester receives the case reference and next action.
4. The owner verifies completion, documents any unresolved issue and schedules a review if the arrangement remains active.

Role	Responsibility
Requester	Provide scope, requested period and synthetic supporting evidence
Compliance owner	Interpret the requirement and assign a decision owner
Independent reviewer	Check approval limits and exception evidence
Record custodian	Retain the case according to the applicable schedule

Worked scenario

Example SYN-COM-005-03: the Cedar project team submits a request with an incomplete review date. The owner returns the case for clarification instead of assuming approval. Once the date and scope are supplied, the rule is applied and the decision is logged.

Exception and evidence

An exception must name the approving role, limited scope and expiry. A verbal suggestion or old FAQ does not override the controlling requirement. Store evidence in the authorized workspace and preserve version context.

Related search terms

Legal hold procedure; Compliance; retention, evidence, legal hold, access review